

of division that were sowed by former prime minister V.P. Singh in the name of caste-based reservations ("Caste Cleft", June 2). We are still reeling under the aftermath of the move.

ADITYA K. AGGARWAL, on e-mail

India Outsourced

Shobhaa De may feel that NRIs are heading back home in droves, the magazine, however, paints an altogether different picture ("The Great Greed Creed", July 2). Out of seven, only two of the distinguished authors whose columns feature in the magazine are based in the country. It is disappointing to see that the task of analysing and presenting India's achievements over the decades had to be outsourced.

UTTARA CHAUHAN, on e-mail

The death toll in the Gujarat riots was nothing when compared to the Sikh riots in Delhi ("Rule of Hate", July 2). Had the ruling party been an accomplice, as alleged by the "intellectuals" and the "secularists", the toll would have reached at least a lakh. Remember Stalin and Hitler?

ASOKE C. BANERJEE, Kolkata

The Great Presidential Race

It does not really matter who the country's prime minister or President is ("High Drama Over High Office", July 2). Everyone knows who the real "ruler" is. RANJANA MANCHANDA, on e-mail

While both India and the US are witness to the rise of women power in the presidential elections, their cases are still different.

While the President of the United States will be elected by the people, the President of India will be more of a nomination that to by elected representatives, the election being a mere formality.

VISWANATHAN S., Chennai

It would have been better had Dr A.P.J. Abdul Kalam flatly refused to reconsider his decision on re-election. He allowed himself to be used as a pawn by the "league of ex-chief minis-

ters" when he expressed his willingness to contest if his victory was certain.

D.B.N. MURTHY, Bangalore

To describe President Kalam as the people's President is wrong. He has not made any concerted effort to help weed out evils like corruption and poverty among others. Save for bravadoes like excursions to mountain tops or ocean depths, he hasn't done anything concrete.

N. DHARMESHWARAN, Chennai

CHILDREN OF A RICH GOD



SHRIVA PATIL

It is disheartening to see a bunch of spoilt brats being projected as representatives of Indian youth ("No Kidding", June 25). Today's teenagers are a focused lot who excel in both academics and co-curricular activities.

BLESSY ABRAHAM, Delhi

The story seems to have missed the teenagers belonging to the economically weaker sections of society, who are influenced by the media and the fashion industry in the same way as their rich counterparts are.

SADHVI KALRA, on e-mail

The cover story, "No Kidding", spread over 10 pages was based on a non-issue and should have been left for the glamour and fashion magazines to cover. It seems the magazine has lost its *atma* in the wake of advertisements.

MAHESH GAUR, Pali-Marwar

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Years Ago in India Today

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Emergency Bonanza

Delhi's cocktail circuit is now divided into two groups: those who have written books on the Emergency and those who haven't. Heading the list of these authors is Kuldip Nayar whose *The Judgement* sold over 50,000 copies.

G.S. Bhargava, *The Hindustan Times'*

Assistant Editor came out with "Indira's India Gate"

which was Popular books just a rehash of news stories. V.K. Narasimhan of *The Indian Express* wrote a "quickie" while the former editor of *The Times of India* D.R. Mankekar and his wife also piled in with their *The Decline and Fall of Indira Gandhi*, a book that was "written in five weeks" and could be read and shelved in two hours. The cake, however, went to the *The Two faces of Indira Gandhi* which could well have applied to most of these authors as they had been ardent supporters of the Emergency.

—Shirley Joshua

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